

Railways

The myriad advances of the 19th century altered lives beyond all recognition; arguably the greatest change was created by railways. By the 1840s, railways reached all parts of England and many other parts of Europe and elsewhere; in 1869, the first transcontinental line linked the east and west coasts of the United States. Railways had become the wonder of the age, and distinctive styles of architecture developed around them. Philip Hardwick (1792–1870), Robert Stephenson (1803–59) and Charles Fox (1810–74) created Euston Station in London in 1837, with its propylaeum (grand gateway) and Doric columns. A determination to outshine the neoclassical King's Cross Station (1851–2) and Great Northern Hotel (1854), designed by Lewis Cubitt (1799–1883), spurred George Gilbert Scott's (1811–78) design for St Pancras Station and Midland Grand Hotel (opposite, 1865–76). Convinced that the Gothic style was the only true Christian style, Scott gave these buildings castellated fringes, dormer windows, towering pointed roofs, banded 'neo-Byzantine' arches and Venetian-inspired façades.

